

Micronesia

The Marshall Islands, Nauru, Palau, and the Federated States of Micronesia, as well as the U.S. territories of Guam, Wake Island, and the Northern Mariana Islands, make up the region known collectively as Micronesia in the northwest Pacific.

I live on an island.

Be more Pacific.

Palau

With an abundance of palm trees, Palau's islanders harvest coconuts for their copra—the dried kernel or nut that is made into coconut oil.

I'm going nuts.

Micronesia

Coral atolls and an array of shipwrecks from World War II attract many scuba-diving tourists to the Federated States of Micronesia.

What a wreck.

Nauru

The world's smallest republic, Nauru has a lunar landscape following the exhaustive mining of its vast reserves of phosphate.

I'm exhausted.

Quick, more sand!

Marshall Islands

Like many others in the Pacific, the inhabitants of the Marshall Islands fear that rising sea levels may engulf their low-lying island nation.

Guam

A major U.S. military base covers one-third of this tropical island, which also entices many tourists.

Melanesia

The Melanesian islands of the southwest Pacific are mostly volcanic in origin and consist of Fiji, the Solomon Islands, Vanuatu, and French-owned New Caledonia.

Solomon Islands

The heavily wooded Solomon Islands introduced a sustainable forest-harvesting policy in 1998 to prevent illegal logging and deforestation.

It's tree time!

This gets nuttier by the minute!

Fiji

The main crop grown on Fiji is sugar cane, which is exported along with copra and gold.

Sweet.

Pass the sugar.

This is golden.

It's a luau!

Polynesia

The far-flung Polynesian islands include Kiribati, Samoa, Tonga, and Tuvalu; the New Zealand-administered Cook Islands, Niue, and Tokelau; French Polynesia and Wallis and Futuna; the British-owned Pitcairn Islands; and distant Easter Island, administered by Chile.

Vanuatu

Once known as the New Hebrides until its independence in 1980, Vanuatu today relies on its exports of cocoa and coconut products.

Hawaii

Lying to the north of Polynesia, Hawaii, formed by the peaks of the world's tallest volcanoes, is the 50th state of the U.S. and a major tourist destination.

Kiribati

Like many Pacific nations, Kiribati's farmers harvest the coconut and use every part of it: copra for oil, and coir fibers for ropes, mats, and brushes.

This is my domain.

Tuvalu

In 1998 Tuvalu sold its ".tv" domain name for use on the Internet by television-related Web sites, bringing in millions of dollars.

I'm a great catch!

Tonga

Uniquely among the Pacific islands, Tonga was never fully colonized and kept its own monarchy.

It's good to be King.

Samoa

Forestry and agriculture provide the main exports for this island nation, while tourism boosts the local income.

Timber!